

Pharmacy staff wellness during COVID-19 and beyond

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Background

- Staff burnout is increasingly recognized as a major concern in healthcare.
- The COVID-19 pandemic presented new unique and persistent stressors that can reduce resilience including personal health concerns, a lack of childcare, and financial strain.
- Yale New Haven Health System (YNHHS) offers a variety of employee support resources, including guided meditation, Reiki, chair massage and therapy dog visits.
- There remained a need to provide health system specialty pharmacy staff with additional and sustainable tools to navigate the pandemic and beyond.

Objectives

- Develop and implement a collection of resources focused on specialty pharmacy staff wellbeing and resilience to address contributors to burnout exacerbated during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Methods

Intervention

- Recurring town hall forum
- Peer support group (STEP OUTT)
- Targeted enrichment activities

Assessment

- Survey of:
 - self-reported perception of current mental health and wellbeing
 - utility of existing services
 - interest in learning more about specific topics and wellbeing resources
- 6 point Likert scale

Analysis

- Survey responses coded such that higher values associated with desired perception
- Continuous variables presented as proportions and mean percent
- Windows Excel 2016

Project Timeline

FY2020 Q4

- Stakeholder identification
- Resource identification
- Project planning

FY2021 Q1

- Stakeholder engagement
- Peer support group facilitator training
- Assessment design

FY2021 Q2

- Baseline assessment
- Launch of town hall and employee support group

FY2021 Q3

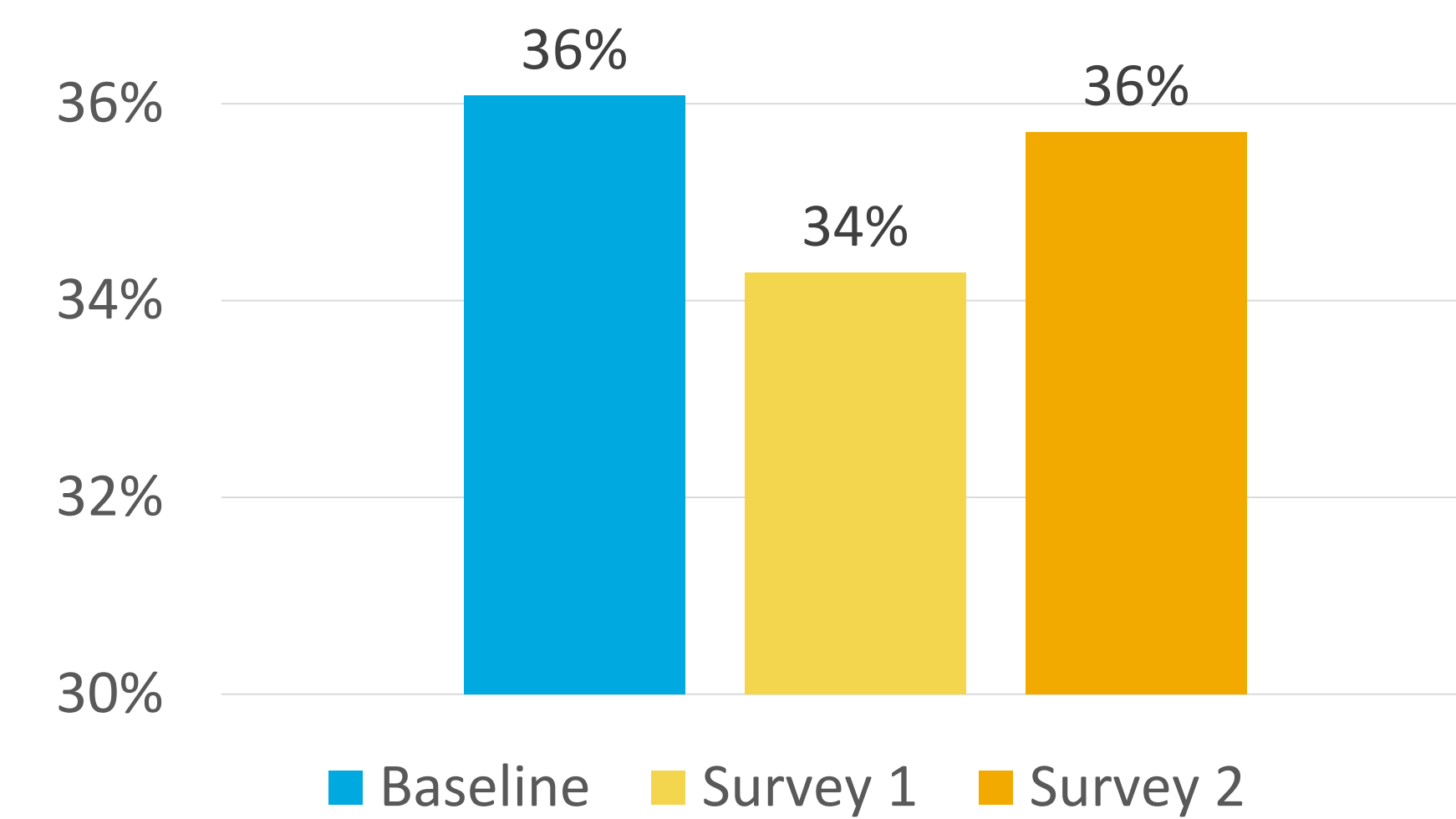
- 3 month assessment
- Tailor wellbeing offerings per survey feedback

FY2021 Q4

- 6 month assessment
- Tailor wellbeing offerings per survey feedback

Results

Survey Response Rate



Wellbeing Enrichment Activities

Baseline	Tailored
- Chair massage - Employee theme days - Mindful meditation - Reiki - Therapy dog visits	- STEP OUTT - Specialty pharmacy wellbeing town halls - Corn hole tournament - On site food trucks - Weekly newsletter

Staff Testimonials

I appreciate all the nice things that are done at OPS and am grateful to work here!

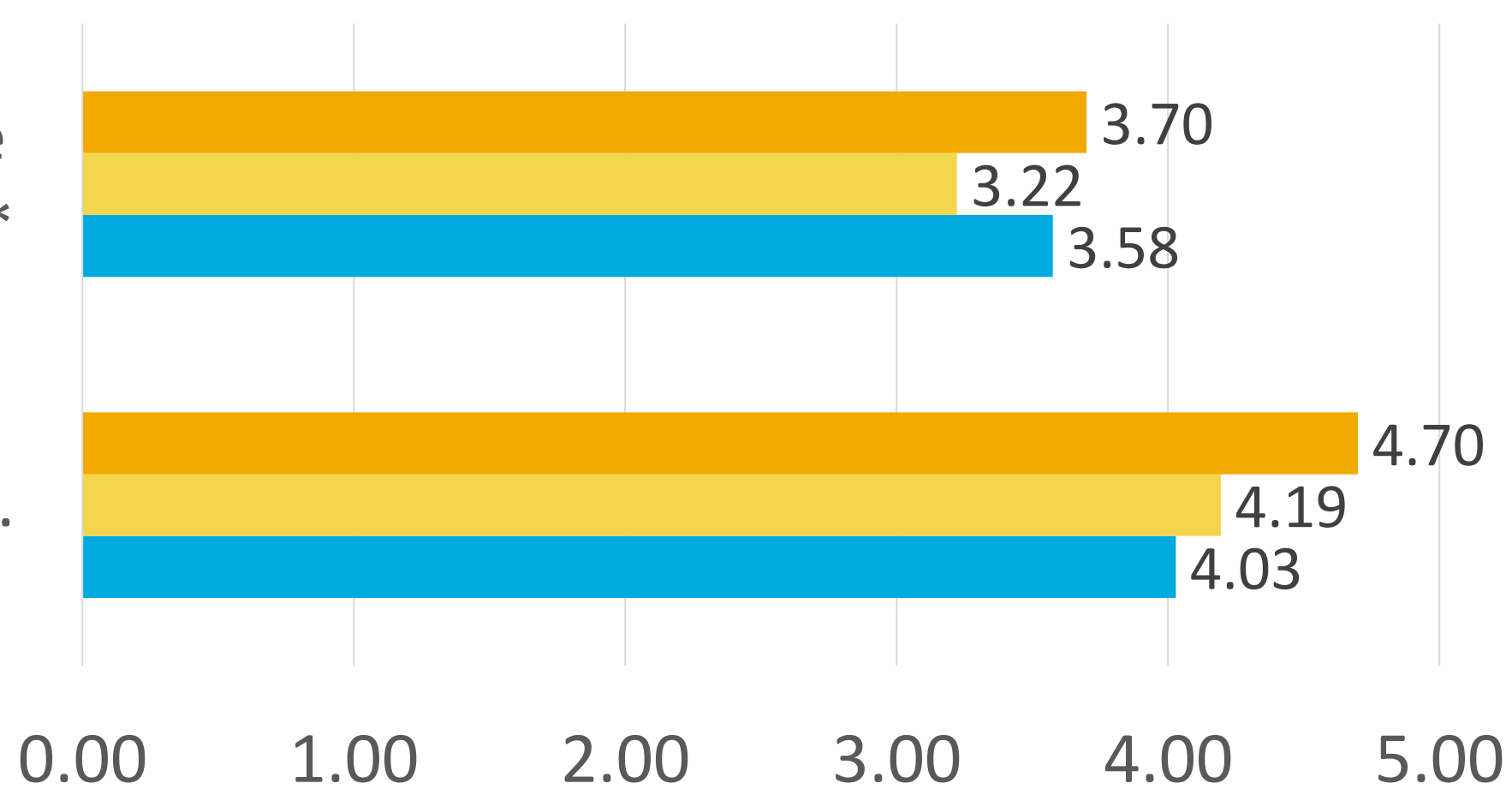
I found the Step OUTT program to be very effective. It was a lovely support driven experience

You all go above and beyond. I can't imagine beginning my journey of specialty pharmacy with any other group of people!

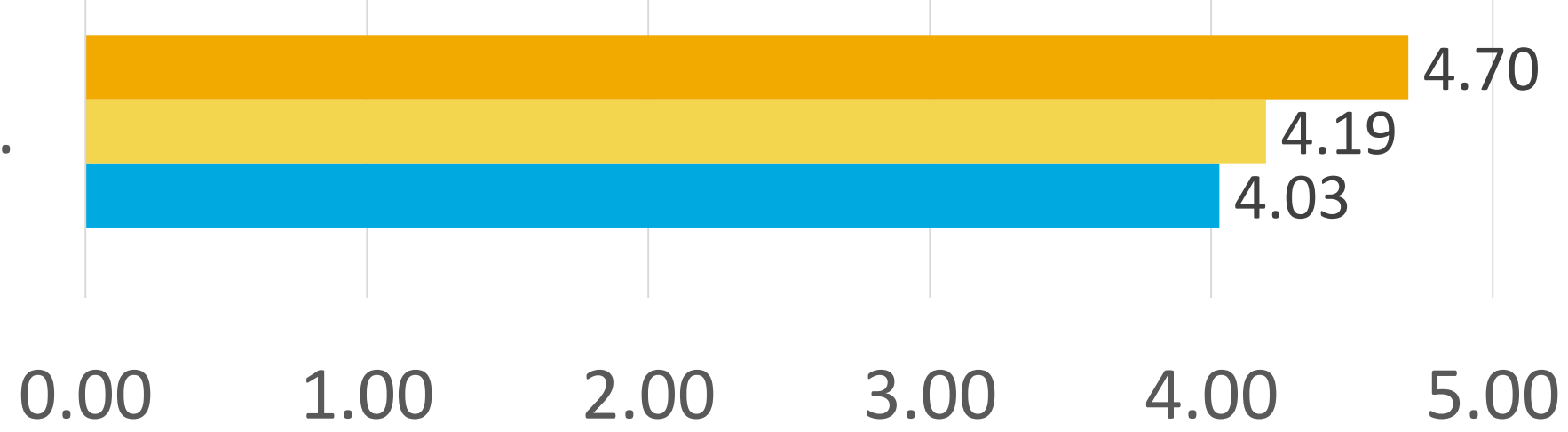
I love working here at OPS- so grateful!! Everyone is nice and friendly.

Safety Assessment

Working with our patients makes me more worried about my own health.*

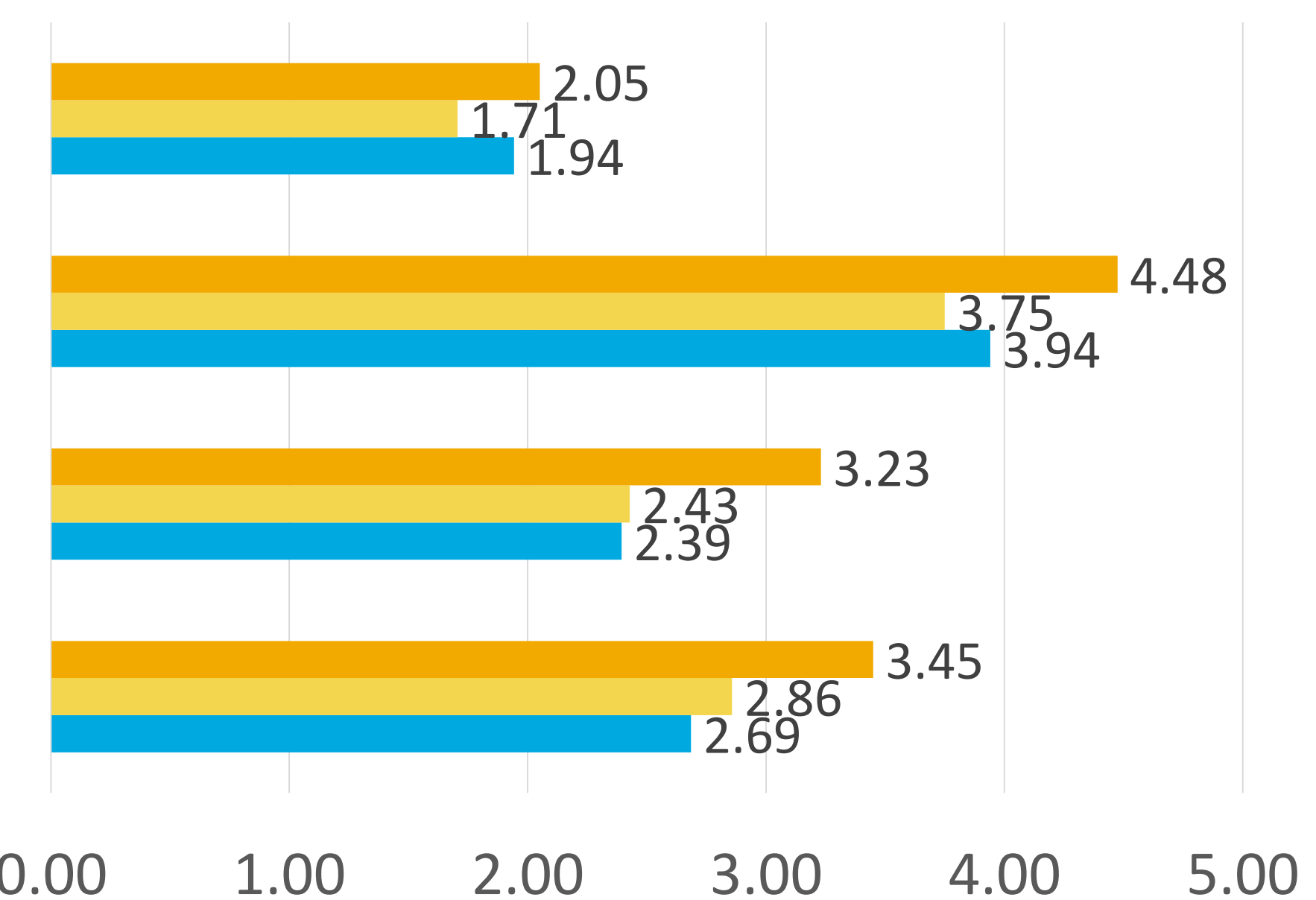


I feel safe at work.



Stress Assessment

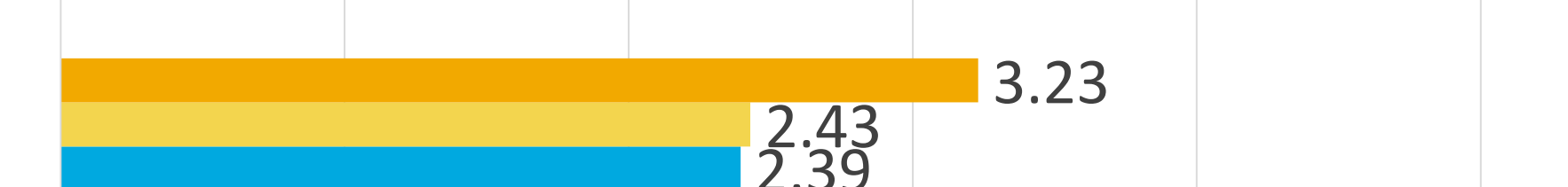
Stress at work impacts my job performance.*



I feel sad, angry, or otherwise negative after speaking with our patients.*



My workplace helps me reduce non work-related stress.



My workplace helps me to reduce work-related stress.



Work Satisfaction Assessment

I have thought about looking for a new job outside of OPS.*



I can depend on the people I work with.



I feel appreciated when I do good work.



I feel welcome and accepted at work.



■ Survey 2 ■ Survey 1 ■ Baseline

*= survey values were coded such that 0= negative perception, 5= positive perception

Discussion

- Survey participation was consistent over six months, with 34% to 36% of employees responding over three reporting periods.
- Staff reported concern with stress impacting job performance, and work impacting work-related and non-work related stress.
- At baseline, 49.5% of respondents were interested in resources for stress management, 23% in balancing work and family and 23% in support during life events.
- Town hall and support group topics included family and the pandemic, self-care, and gratitude.
- Support group attendance doubled from 10% to 20% staff engagement since implementation.
- Employees perceived the town hall and support groups as increasingly important for wellbeing.

Conclusions

- A recurring pharmacy wellbeing survey paired with tailored peer focused interventions can be used to meet evolving staff needs at a health system specialty pharmacy during COVID-19 and beyond.

Barriers / Limitations

Barriers

- Offered multiple sessions for each enrichment activity to allow staff participation without sacrificing patient care.
- Identified administrative support to coordinate peer support group sessions to free capacity of pharmacist and liaison peer support group volunteers.

Limitations

- Pharmacists and liaisons concentrated at a single location; consideration needed to adapt to for a decentralized staffing model.

Future Directions

- Training of additional peer support facilitator to accommodate increased participation
- Expanding peer support group session offerings to include activity and craft-based sessions

Disclosure: The authors of this presentation have the following to disclose concerning possible financial or personal relationships with commercial entities that may have a direct or indirect interest in the subject matter of this presentation: Kimhouy Tong, PharmD, BCPS; Terri Sue Bukowski, PharmD; Rebecca Reeve, PharmD; Jason Meier, MA, CPhT; Samuel Gyawu-Amoateng, PharmD; Wanda Taylor, MHA; Brittany Dasher, CPhT; Vinay Sawant, RPh, MPH, MBA: nothing to disclose.
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